

Arthropleura

arth-row-PLOO-ra



- **When** 350 million years ago (Early Carboniferous)
- **Fossil location** Scotland
- **Habitat** Forests
- **Length** Up to 8½ ft (2 m)
- **Diet** Unknown

Arthropleura lived on the dark, damp floor of tropical jungles during the Carboniferous Period. Fossils of its mouth have not been found, making its diet a mystery, but traces of ferns in its gut suggest it was a plant-eater. Although able to breathe out of water, it probably stayed in damp places and may have had to return to water to shed its skin as it grew. Some scientists think it could also swim under water.



▲ **CREEPY CREATURE** *Arthropleura*'s body consisted of 30 segments, each with a pair of legs. Fossilized footprints show it swerving around obstacles and suggest it could move quickly, lengthening its stride to speed up.

INVERTEBRATES



LIVING RELATIVE

Millipede means "a thousand feet," but most millipedes have only 100–300 legs. Despite all the legs, they are slow walkers, their tiny feet swinging forward in waves. They feed on rotting plant matter, burrowing into soil to find it. Centipedes, in contrast, are fast-moving hunters that kill with venomous claws.



251

200

145

65

23

Now

Permian

Triassic

Jurassic

Cretaceous

Paleogene

Neogene